

SELLING HVAC FOR BEGINNERS

RIV COMFORT

Internal Sales Course

Course Outline

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For New Sales Representatives

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1. INDUSTRY OVERVIEW & OPPORTUNITY

Why HVAC is Different from Solar

****The Problem We Solve:****

- High power bills caused by inefficient HVAC systems
- Old units degrade from 80% efficiency down to 50% or below
- Homeowners are essentially "pouring gasoline on the ground" with wasted energy

****Market Advantage:****

- HVAC is virtually untouched by door-to-door sales at scale
- Traditional HVAC companies are reactive (wait for systems to break)
- We are proactive (prevent failure before it happens)
- Less educational groundwork needed compared to solar
- Customers already understand the value—they just need affordable solutions

****Why People Need This Now:****

- Aging systems are failing
- High utility bills are draining budgets
- Fear of system failure during extreme weather
- No affordable financing options from traditional companies

2. YOUR ROLE & PERSONA

How to Present Yourself

****What You Are NOT:****

- Don't be overly polished or professional (that's solar energy salesman energy)
- Don't wear fancy clothes that will get dirty
- Don't pretend to know more than you do

****What You ARE:****

- An electrical contractor who specializes in HVAC
- Blue-collar, capable, and trustworthy
- Someone who gets the job done

Recommended Appearance

****Clothing:****

- ****Shirt:**** Work shirt (collared button-up, clearly a work shirt—not a polo)
- ****Pants:**** 5.11 tactical pants or cargo pants/shorts
- ****Shoes:**** Work boots or sturdy shoes (black Air Max or similar work-appropriate footwear)
- ***Pro tip:** Wear them with visible wear and tear—shows you actually work

****Why This Matters:****

- HVAC techs make \$60-100K/year and dress accordingly
- Showing up in \$300 shoes and pristine clothes signals you're not what you claim to be
- Your appearance builds trust and rapport

****Accessories:****

- Flashlight (essential for inspections)
- Small screwdriver (for furnace access)
- Measuring tape
- Phone/iPad for photos and documentation

3. DOOR-TO-DOOR APPROACH

The Foundation: Be Direct & Simple

The most effective door approaches are surprisingly simple. Overcomplicating kills deals.

Door Approach #1 (Neighbor Reference)

****Script:****

> "Hey, I'm [Your Name]. We're just electrical contractors. We've been working with some of your neighbors. We specialize in heating and cooling. [Specific neighbor name] found that his system was super old, and there are programs out there that make it close to free. So we're out here just offering free inspections for his neighbors. Real quick—is your unit on the back left or right?"

****Key Elements:****

- Firm handshake, direct eye contact
- Mention electrical contractors (not solar—avoids door slamming)
- Reference a specific neighbor
- Explain the benefit (programs make it close to free)
- Ask a simple, direct question about unit location
- Don't over-explain

Door Approach #2 (Appointment Backup)

****Script:****

> "Hey, we were here to meet with [neighbor name] about their heating and cooling system. They're running a couple hours late, so we're trying to make the best use of our time. We're offering free inspections on HVAC units that are more than 10 years old. Do you know if yours is more or less than 10 years old?"

****When to Use:**** When you have a legitimate appointment nearby that's running late

Critical Rule: First Person to Talk Loses

- After you ask where their unit is, ****wait****
- Silence is uncomfortable for them, not you
- They'll either answer or say no
- If they say no → respect it and move on ("Have a good day")
- If they say yes → they're already committed

What Happens Next

****If They Say Yes:****

- They will almost always walk you to the unit
- Follow them, take control of the situation
- You're now in the sales process

****If They Say No:****

- Don't push
- Move to the next door
- ~5% of doors say no—that's normal

4. IN-HOME SALES PROCESS

Phase 1: Exterior Unit Inspection

****What You Do:****

1. Walk to the HVAC unit with confidence
2. Immediately take a photo of the unit
3. Get the model number and serial number
4. Take a step back and observe

****What You Say:****

> "Wow, this unit's pretty old. It's like a big diesel motor on the side of your house."

****Why This Works:****

- You're building initial awareness
- Setting up the next question naturally
- Not being pushy—just observational

Phase 2: Interior Unit Discovery

****Your Question:****

> "Do you have the matching unit on the inside?"

****Expected Responses:****

- ****75% don't know:**** "I'm not sure" → "I just need to see it real quick"
- ****25% do know:**** "Yeah, it's a Bryant system" → "Oh sick, I just need to see it real quick so I can get the model and serial number"

****Key Point:**** You've never had someone refuse to show you the interior unit (except one case: a single mom concerned about a large man in her home—solution: coach her to take the pictures herself)

Phase 3: Furnace Interior Inspection (The Pain Builder)

****Setup:****

- Take the front panel off the furnace
- Look for model/serial number (usually inside on left or right panel)
- ****This is where the magic happens****

****What You'll Find (Usually):****

- Water inside
- Rust
- Debris
- Animal droppings
- Damaged wiring/motherboard
- Mold or mildew

****How to Open the Furnace:****

- ****Carrier systems:**** Two small nozzles on each side—twist and pull up
- ****Bryant systems:**** Screws in the middle—unscrew them
- ****Other systems:**** Look for a handle or use your screwdriver
- ***Bring a small screwdriver—you'll need it sometimes***

Phase 4: Building Urgency Through Pain

****When You See Water:****

> "You see that water? Such a good thing I stopped today. We both know water is not supposed to be in there. You see all these electronics exposed? What do you think happens to wiring and motherboards when water gets on it? It's a good thing I stopped by, so you didn't have to deal with the problems that are about to happen."

****When You See Rust:****

> "Sir, you have all this rust. You getting water in here? God forbid it hits this motherboard. I'm so glad I stopped today and talked to you guys."

****When You See Animal Damage:****

> "You got a bunch of mice in here. These wires are coated with soy and these mice love to eat them. You'd end up waking up one day with no furnace. It's a good thing I stopped by."

****Critical:**** Don't put the furnace back together if there's visible damage. Leave it open and say:

> "I'm going to leave it open. We'll be able to get this fixed for you. No big deal."

Phase 5: Transition to Close

****Your Line:****

> "Where's somewhere I can sit so I can show this to you?"

****NOT:**** "Where can I sell this to you?"

****NOT:**** "Let me talk business with you"

You're showing, not selling.

Phase 6: Filling Out the Application

****What You're Doing:****

- Sitting down with customer
- Pulling up the sales platform on your iPad
- Filling in basic info (first name, last name, phone, email)
- Uploading your photos

****What You're Saying (Build the Case):****

> "Mr./Ms. [Name], I'm so glad I stopped today. We both know it's not broken right now—obviously, or this house would be super uncomfortable. I'm not here to insult your intelligence and tell you it's broken. I am here to tell you that you need to get it done. Here's why:

>

> ****Number one:**** It's super old.

>

> ****Number two:**** We saw that damage when we opened up the furnace.

>

> ****Number three:**** If your furnace goes down, the likelihood that your AC goes down more than doubles or triples.

>

> My recommendation is, before you run into all these issues and have to recharge a system that costs \$3,000-\$5,000 just to recharge, we get this replaced."

5. OBJECTION HANDLING

Objection #1: "It's Not Broken"

****Your Response:****

> "I'm not here to tell you it's broken. I'm here to tell you that you need to get it done. It's 30 years old. We saw damage when we opened it up. And if your furnace goes down, your AC is much more likely to fail too. This is like changing the oil in your car—you do maintenance before it breaks."

****Analogy That Works:****

> "So you probably don't change the oil in your car either, do you? Of course you do. Then of course you need this."

****If They're Male with a Family:****

> "You got four kids running around here and a wife who's probably going to cut your hands off if you can't get an HVAC guy here in 24 hours. Let me be honest with you, man."

Objection #2: "I Can Find It Cheaper"

****Your Response:****

> "You absolutely can. And if you want to swipe a credit card or write me a check, I can definitely get you a cheaper deal. However, this is financing. Let me ask you a question: When you buy a car, do you pay the cash price or do you finance it and pay more than the car is actually worth because you financed it?"

****They'll say:**** "I finance it"

****Your Close:****

> "Okay, so are you prepared to pay \$15,000 cash today? If you are, then we can do a cash price. But most people like to keep their cash and pay \$200 a month. That way you keep your money and pay it off in the next two years."

Objection #3: "I'll Deal With It When It Breaks"

****Your Response:****

> "So you probably don't change the oil in your car either, do you? Of course you do. Then of course you need this. It's 30 years old. What happens if it goes out in August when it's 100 degrees outside? You're going to be vulnerable. The HVAC guy knows you're desperate, so he's not going to give you a good deal. Your family's going to be uncomfortable. I stopped by today to prevent that from happening."

****The Real Talk:****

> "You're at a point where you have 300,000 miles on your car. I'd be telling you not to leave town so you don't end up in the back of a tow truck paying thousands of dollars to get home. The cool part is I stopped here today and pointed this out to you so you don't end up without heating

or cooling on the hottest or coldest day of the year."

Objection #4: "I Don't Want to Finance"

****Your Response:****

> "That makes total sense, man. Neither do I. The cool part about our membership is that it's a lease. It's not on your credit unless you don't pay it. Then you kind of deserve it on your credit."

****Then laugh with them.**** This breaks tension.

Objection #5: "The Interest Rate is 11%"

****Your Response:****

> "The average home improvement loan is anywhere from 9-15% interest. If you don't believe me, ChatGPT it. Most home improvement loans don't have the best interest rates.

>

> Most HVAC companies have financing over five years at 60 months, and your payment would be \$800-\$1,000 a month. We spread it out over time so you're able to make the cheapest payment possible and make this affordable for everybody.

>

> Now, if you want to pay \$800-\$900 a month, Mr./Ms. [Name], it doesn't actually matter to us. You'll just pay it off a lot quicker and avoid paying all that interest you're talking about."

Objection #6: "I Need to Think About It / Talk to My Spouse"

****Your Response:****

> "I totally understand. That's actually pretty dumb not to do this, don't you think? Here's what we're going to do: I'm going to run your credit real quick. If you get approved, you don't have to do anything today. But at least you'll know you have the option. And when you talk to your [spouse], you can tell them you're approved and just need to sign the paperwork."

****Then run the credit.**** Getting approved removes the biggest objection.

6. PRODUCT KNOWLEDGE

The Three Package Options

Comfort Package — \$3,000 Profit

- Standard furnace/AC replacement
- Basic equipment swap
- 5-year parts & service warranty
- **Best for:** Budget-conscious customers, straightforward replacements

Comfort Plus Package — \$5,000 Profit

- Upgraded equipment
- Better efficiency
- Enhanced warranty
- **Best for:** Mid-range customers wanting better performance

Big Daddy Package — \$7,000 Profit

- **Dual Fuel System** (heat pump + furnace for maximum efficiency)
- **200-Amp Panel Upgrade** (included—great for solar customers)
- **Airflow Optimization** (ductwork improvements, pressure testing)
- **Smart Thermostat** (programmable, remote control)
- **Advanced Filtration System** (self-cleaning, longer lifespan, healthier home)
- **Best for:** Customers wanting the complete solution, solar customers needing panel upgrades

Why Dual Fuel is Amazing

What It Is:

- A heat pump (electric) + furnace (gas) system
- Uses the most efficient heating method automatically
- Heat pump in spring/fall, furnace in deep winter

Real Customer Story:

A 4-story home with 4 thermostats couldn't keep temperatures within 5 degrees of each other (161°, 170°, 175°, 172°). After installing a Big Daddy dual fuel system, all thermostats read within 1 degree of each other.

****Selling Point:****

> "This system will give you better comfort than you've ever had. Every customer I've put this in loves it."

7. FINANCING OPTIONS

Option 1: Membership/PPA

****What It Is:****

- A lease-like agreement
- Covers ALL maintenance, warranties, repairs, and replacements
- Customer never worries about the system again

****Monthly Payment:**** Typically \$200-\$300/month

****Term:**** 20 years

****Advantages:****

- No credit impact (unless they don't pay)
- Covers everything
- Predictable costs
- Great for risk-averse customers

****How to Pitch:****

> "This covers all maintenance, all warranties, repairs, replacements—you never worry about it again. It's just a couple hundred bucks a couple months after we get it installed."

Option 2: Loan

****What It Is:****

- Traditional financing
- Customer owns the system after paying it off
- 5-year parts & service warranty included

****Monthly Payment:**** Typically \$200-\$300/month

****Term:**** 20 years

****Interest Rate:**** ~11% (standard for home improvement loans)

****Advantages:****

- Customer owns the equipment
- Builds equity
- Can pay off early without penalty
- Lower total cost than membership over time

****How to Pitch:****

> "You own the system outright after you pay it off. It comes with a 5-year parts and service warranty. Your payment never changes."

Credit Tier Differences

****Lower Credit Tier Option:****

- Lower credit requirement (605+)
- ****BUT:**** Heavy debt-to-income check
- If DTI is bad, they fail even with good credit

****Higher Credit Tier Option:****

- 650+ credit requirement
- No debt-to-income check after 650
- Better for customers with high DTI but decent credit

****Strategy:**** If one option fails, try the other. Different criteria = different approvals.

What NOT to Over-Explain

- Don't go into detail about interest rates unless asked
- Don't explain the difference between PPA and lease
- Don't complicate the close with rebates or incentives
- **Keep it simple:** "Your payment is \$X and it never changes."

8. COMMISSION STRUCTURE

Fixed Profit Margins

| Package | Your Profit |

|-----|-----|

| Comfort | \$3,000 |

| Comfort Plus | \$5,000 |

| Big Daddy | \$7,000 |

Important: These are FIXED. You make the same amount regardless of final price.

Adders (Additional Costs)

What Are They?

- Extra work needed (boiler removal, extensive ductwork, gas line runs, etc.)
- Usually \$200-\$300 per job

Company Protection:

- Company absorbs the first **\$1,500** in adders
- You keep your full commission
- Only pay out of pocket if adders exceed \$1,500

When You'll See Big Adders:

- Converting from boiler to furnace (major construction)
- Extensive ductwork replacement

- New gas line installation
- Panel upgrades beyond standard

****Real Example:****

- Boiler removal + furnace + new ductwork + new gas lines = \$12,500 in adders
- Rep still made \$4,000 (Big Daddy profit)
- Company absorbed \$1,500, contractor ate the rest

****How to Avoid Big Adder Deals:****

- If you see a boiler, push mini-split systems instead
- If customer insists on furnace, let them know it's construction-heavy
- Know your market—some homes are easier than others

9. QUICK REFERENCE CHECKLIST

Pre-Door Knock

- [] Wearing work clothes (not overly polished)
- [] Have flashlight
- [] Have small screwdriver
- [] Have phone/iPad for photos
- [] Know your door approach script
- [] Confident mindset

Door Knock

- [] Firm handshake, direct eye contact
- [] Mention "electrical contractors"
- [] Reference a specific neighbor
- [] Explain the benefit (close to free)
- [] Ask about unit location
- [] Wait for response (first to talk loses)

Exterior Unit

- [] Take photo of unit
- [] Get model and serial number
- [] Make observation ("This unit's pretty old")
- [] Ask about interior unit

Interior Unit

- [] Get model and serial number
- [] Build rapport while walking

Furnace Interior

- [] Open the front panel carefully
- [] Look for model/serial inside
- [] Document any damage (water, rust, animals, debris)
- [] Build rapport with what you see
- [] Don't close it back up if damage is present

Transition to Close

- [] Say "Where can I sit so I can show this to you?"
- [] Sit down with customer
- [] Make the case (old, damaged, risk of failure)
- [] Move to financing conversation

Closing

- [] Ask: "Membership or loan?"
- [] If objections: Use your scripts
- [] Run credit
- [] Send documents
- [] Get signature

Follow-Up

- [] Track deal in system
- [] Monitor approval status
- [] Prepare for verification call
- [] Coordinate with installation team

FINAL REMINDERS

- ✓ ****Less is more.**** Simpler pitches close more deals.
- ✓ ****You don't need to be an expert.**** "I'm the electrical guy, we have a certified tech" is a complete sentence.
- ✓ ****Build pain, not features.**** Show them the problem, don't lecture about efficiency.
- ✓ ****Assume the sale.**** Don't put the furnace back together if there's damage.
- ✓ ****Stay confident.**** You're offering a solution to a real problem they already know they have.
- ✓ ****Ask for help when you need it.**** Don't guess your way through deals.

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